

MODULE 3 : LANGUAGE FOCUS PRIME LANGUAGE ACADEMY

Passé Continu (The Past Continuous Tense)

1. Affirmative Form

a) Uses (Utilisations):

- (Décrit une action en cours à un moment donné dans le passé.) Describes an action ongoing at a specific point in the past.
- (Décrit une action en cours interrompue par une action plus brève.) Describes an ongoing action interrupted by a shorter action.

b) Structure (Structure):

Subject + was/were + verb-ing

Example :

- I was studying French when my sister arrived. (J'étudiais le français quand ma sœur est arrivée.)

c) Examples :

- She was cooking dinner when the phone rang. (Elle faisait la cuisine quand le téléphone a sonné.)
- We were watching TV when the light went out. (Nous regardions la télévision quand la lumière s'est éteinte.)
- They were playing football in the park when I saw them. (Ils jouaient au football dans le parc quand je les ai vus.)
- I was reading a book when you came in. (Je lisais un livre quand tu es entré.)
- She was waiting for the bus when it started to rain. (Elle attendait le bus quand il a commencé à pleuvoir.)

2. Negative Form

a) Uses (Utilisations):

- Negates an ongoing action at a specific point in the past. (Nie une action en cours à un moment donné dans le passé.)

b) Structure (Structure):

Subject + wasn't/weren't + verb-ing

Example :

- They weren't playing football when I arrived. (Ils ne jouaient pas au football quand je suis arrivé.)

c) Examples

- I wasn't working last night. (Je ne travaillais pas hier soir.)
- She wasn't watching television. (Elle ne regardait pas la télévision.)
- We weren't eating yet. (Nous ne mangions pas encore.)
- They weren't doing their homework. (Ils ne faisaient pas leurs devoirs.)
- You weren't sleeping when I called you. (Tu ne dormais pas quand je t'ai appelé.)

3. Interrogative Form (Forme interrogative):

a) Structure (Structure):

Was/Were + Subject + verb-ing + ?

Example

- **Was she cooking** dinner when you arrived? (Est-ce qu'elle **faisait la cuisine** quand tu es arrivé ?)

b) Examples

- **Were they playing** football in the park yesterday afternoon? (Est-ce qu'ils **jouaient** au football dans le parc hier après-midi ?)
- **Was it raining** when you left the house? (Est-ce qu'il **pleuvait** quand tu es sorti de la maison ?)
- **Were you working** late last night? (Est-ce que tu **travillais** tard hier soir ?)
- **Was she sleeping** when the phone rang? (Est-ce qu'elle **dormait** quand le téléphone a sonné ?)

4. Negative Interrogative Form

a) Structure (Structure):

Wasn't/Weren't + Subject + verb-ing + ?

Example

- **Weren't they playing** games when you interrupted them? (Est-ce qu'ils **ne jouaient pas** à des jeux quand tu les as interrompus ?)

b) Examples

- **Wasn't she studying** for her exam last night? (Est-ce qu'elle **n'étudiait pas** pour son examen hier soir ?)
- **Weren't we watching** a movie a few minutes ago? (Est-ce qu'on **ne regardait pas** un film il y a quelques minutes ?)
- **Wasn't it getting** dark when we left the beach? (Est-ce qu'il **ne commençait pas** à faire noir quand on a quitté la plage ?)
- **Weren't you feeling well** yesterday? (Est-ce que tu **ne te sentais pas** bien hier ?)

Note: To form questions in the negative interrogative form, simply use "wasn't" or "weren't" before the subject.

5. Active/Passive Voice

The Past Continuous Tense can be used in both the active and passive voice.

a) Active Voice:

The subject performs the action.

- **Example:** She was cooking dinner. (Elle **faisait la cuisine**.)

b) Passive Voice:

The subject receives the action.

- **Example:** Dinner was being cooked by her. (Le dîner était en train d'être cuit par elle.)

1. Worksheet

Part One: Text & Dialogue

Text

The sun was shining and the birds were singing. I was walking in the park when I met my friend David. He was jogging and he suggested I run with him. I declined because I was tired and I preferred to simply enjoy the weather. We were talking for a while then David continued his run and I went home.

b) Dialogue (Dialogue):

- **Sarah:** What **were** you **doing** when I called you last night?
- **Marc:** I **was having** dinner with my family.
- **Sarah:** And what **was** your brother **doing**?
- **Marc:** He **was watching** television.

Part Two: Practice Activities

a) Rewrite the following sentences in the negative past continuous tense.

1. They **were playing** basketball at the gym. ()
2. She **was studying** French in the library. ()
3. We **were watching** a movie at home. ()
4. He **was working** on his computer. ()
5. I **was reading** a book in the garden. ()

b) Write questions in the interrogative form of the past continuous tense for the following sentences.

1. She arrived late. ()
2. They left early. ()
3. You went to the store. ()
4. We cooked dinner. ()
5. He took a nap. ()

c) Rewrite the following sentences in the passive voice of the past continuous tense.

1. The teacher **was explaining** the lesson. ()
2. The mechanic **was repairing** my car. ()
3. The chef **was preparing** dinner. ()
4. The children **were cleaning** their room. ()
5. The hair stylist **was cutting** my hair. ()

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